

Matthew Rowlands

Product Marketing & Growth Leader

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Product marketing professional with proven track record building 0→1 products that drive engagement, retention, and revenue. Deep expertise in gamification, behavioral psychology, and growth mechanics demonstrated through live SaaS platforms serving paying customers. Combines technical product development capabilities with strategic go-to-market execution and aggressive sales performance. Currently scaling Melbourne Cup Sweep Manager targeting **\$500k ARR** across **6,900+** Australian venues.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Product Strategy & Execution: Customer retention mechanics • Feature prioritization • Gamification & behavioral UX • Product positioning & messaging • 0→1 product development • Go-to-market strategy • SEO & organic growth

Technical & Analytical: Full-stack development (Next.js, React, Node.js, TypeScript, PostgreSQL) • Payment systems (Stripe) • Real-time architecture • AI integration (Claude, OpenAI) • Data analysis • Cross-functional collaboration

Growth & Engagement: User acquisition • Retention optimization • Viral growth mechanics • Economic incentive design • Community building • A/B testing & rapid iteration • Sales execution (50 calls/day)

Marketing & Communication: Customer research & insights • Messaging & positioning • Content strategy • Multi-channel marketing • SEO optimization (#1 Google rankings) • Stakeholder communication

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Product Lead & Founder | Melbourne Cup Sweep Manager

Aug 2024 – Present

Mallacoota, VIC

Building and scaling live SaaS platform digitizing sweepstakes for Australian hospitality venues. Currently serving paying customers with aggressive expansion targeting **\$500k ARR** at 30% market penetration (2,500 venues).

Product Strategy & Market Positioning:

- Identified **\$multi-million** market opportunity through firsthand venue operations experience: **6,900+** Australian pubs, clubs, RSLs struggling with manual sweep chaos during peak service periods
- Positioned as "Keno meets Trackside"—built complete platform solving operational pain points: QR registration, live TV displays, automated draws, real-time payment tracking, multi-tenant architecture
- Achieved **#1 Google ranking** for "Melbourne Cup Sweep 2025" after 12 months of strategic SEO; executing **50 venue calls daily** targeting \$500k ARR
- Built and shipped production platform as solo technical founder (Next.js, TypeScript, Supabase, Stripe) with self-service UX requiring zero support calls during peak service periods
- Secured first paying customer (Tennis Australia), successful live venue testing, active pipeline across major venue groups

Key Achievement: Validated product-market fit through live venue testing and paying customers while achieving organic discovery through strategic SEO, demonstrating both product execution and marketing capabilities.

Marketing Manager | Doomsday NFT

2023 – 2024

Remote

Led product marketing and engagement strategy for on-chain survival game, designing comprehensive retention mechanics that aligned player psychology with economic incentives.

- Designed multi-layered retention system creating three distinct player archetypes organically (evacuators, reinforcers, tactical players); implemented **0.01 ETH** hit confirmation rewards
- Repositioned messaging from "NFT project" to "on-chain survival game" broadening market appeal; sourced **38,000-city database** enabling personalization and viral growth
- Built tactical map visualization, FOMO-driven floor price mechanism, and scaling prize pool aligning player incentives with project success

Product Lead & Developer | LinkedIn Executive Dashboard (X-Team)

2024

Remote

Built enterprise SaaS platform for X-Team enabling executives to optimize LinkedIn presence without expensive API access (saved **\$5k/year** + avoided months-long approval).

- Avoided LinkedIn API through Claude Vision API for screenshot analysis; designed AI-powered content generation using personality types and department-specific voices (**11 departments**)
- Shipped production platform (React, Node.js, PostgreSQL, Slack integration) with **98.67% test coverage, 352 passing tests, B+ security rating**
- Created **15 Slack commands** enabling seamless user interaction; optimized AI costs to **\$1.60/month per user**

Founder | Your Mate Agency

Jan 2023 – Present

Mallacoota, VIC

Founded 100% Indigenous-owned digital marketing agency serving regional Australian small businesses. Built SaaS model from 0→5 paying clients (\$97-\$397/month) achieving **100% retention** over 24 months.

- Designed voice-first mobile interface transforming business owner "Yarns" (voice notes) into professional marketing content via AI—removed biggest adoption barrier
- Identified underserved market: regional businesses can't afford Melbourne agencies (\$3k-10k/month); created distinctly Australian "matey" brand voice
- Developed comprehensive business plan for Indigenous Business Australia funding (**\$30,250 grant**); built lead generation system with automated PDF reports

Marine Electronics Specialist | Independent Contractor

2020 – Present

Mallacoota, VIC

Technical installation services for marine electronics, wireless audio systems, and communications equipment. Complex system integration, troubleshooting, and project management.

Opening Manager | Scallywags Restaurant & Bar

2019 – 2020

Mallacoota, VIC

Led restaurant opening: operations setup, staff training, service delivery. Deep hospitality venue understanding informed Melbourne Cup Sweep Manager product development.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Development & Technical: Next.js, React, Node.js, TypeScript, JavaScript, PostgreSQL (Supabase), Stripe payments, Real-time WebSocket architecture, Git version control, Vercel deployment, Multi-tenant SaaS architecture	AI & Automation: Claude API integration, OpenAI integration, Claude Vision API, AI content generation, Prompt engineering
Product & Analytics: A/B testing methodologies, User research and interviews, Wireframing and product documentation, Financial modeling and projections, SEO optimization (achieving #1 Google rankings)	Marketing & Growth: Content strategy and creation, Email marketing automation, Social media strategy, Community building, Lead generation systems, Sales execution (50 calls/day)

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Industry Connections: AHA Victoria network access through venue industry relationships • Indigenous Business Australia engagement for funding and growth support • Active member, Mallacoota Chamber of Commerce
Professional Development: Self-directed technical skill development across full-stack development, product management, and digital marketing • Demonstrated ability to ship production-grade code while executing sales and marketing simultaneously

REFERENCES

Available upon request